ANTI-MUSIC MANIFESTO

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The “My plan” column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students’ hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Introduction. Discuss what anti-music means. Brainstorm concepts.	Slides 1–7: hook, what anti-music is, three rules to break, steps 1 and 2, intention over accident. Hand out the project sheet, the Rules page and the Concept sheet.	Slides 1–7	p. 10, p. 12, p. 16, p. 17, p. 18, p. 20
CLASS 2	**Class 2:** Gather sounds, begin building. Write initial concept notes.	Slides 8–10: the sound chain, where sounds come from, a live demo. Students fill in the Sound log and finish the Concept sheet.	Slides 8–10	p. 12, p. 13
CLASS 3	**Classes 3–5:** Working days — build, shape, refine.	Slide 11: build, shape, refine. Then work time.	Slide 11	p. 14
CLASS 4		Slides 12–13: the worked example on paper and the “is it on purpose?” test. Then work time.	Slides 12–13	p. 14
CLASS 5		Full working day: refine and layer. Ask each student to play you the moment where the rule breaks.	No new slides	—
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Write artist statement. Final mix and bounce. Prepare presentations.	Slides 14–17: artist statement, mix and bounce, what to turn in, the rubric. Students self-score and post their three questions.	Slides 14–17	p. 15, p. 19, p. 21
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 18–19: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate’s questions. Reflection (page 22) follows the presentations.	Slides 18–19	p. 21, p. 22

THE ONE RULE FOR CLASS 1

Students define the concept BEFORE they build (my first struggle). No session opens until the Concept sheet (page 12) names a rule and a reason. Slide 2 is the listening routine my notes suggest.

CLASSES 3–5

Working days. Class 5 has no new slide. Circulate and ask: which rule is this breaking, and how would a listener know it was on purpose?

PREVIEW

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EXAMPLE

Worked example · an invented piece

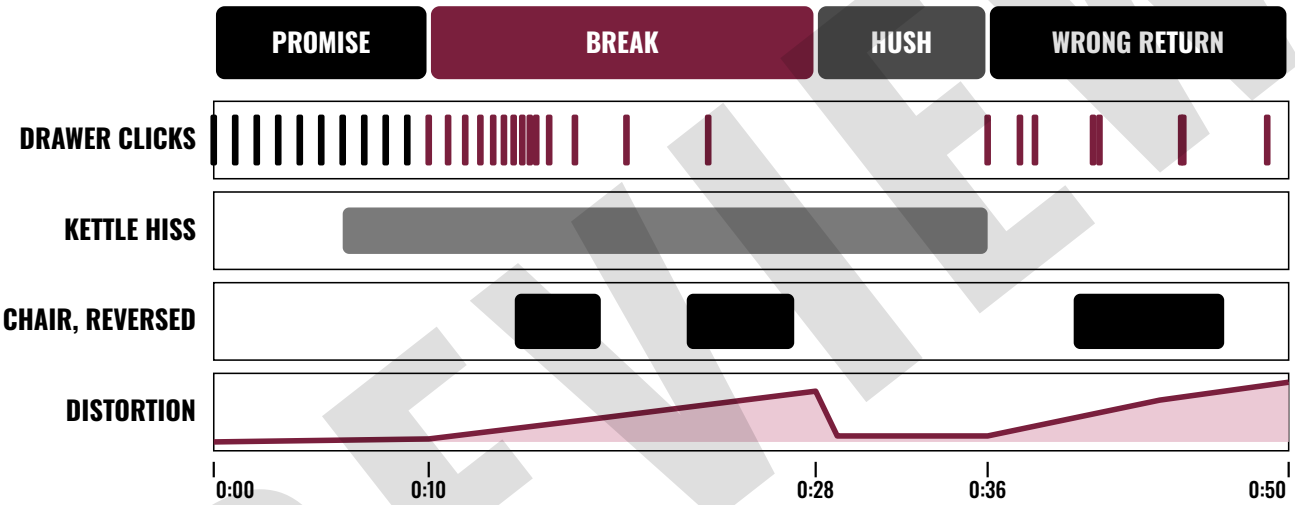
Teacher

An **invented piece, "Kitchen Table", and its artist statement, described on paper**: no audio is included, so the numbers are easy to check. Students' pieces will differ.

1 · THE CONCEPT ·

RULE BROKEN	CONCEPT	SOUNDS (RECORDED)	EFFECTS AND AUTOMATION
Rhythm: a steady pulse	A pulse is a promise; the piece breaks it, then returns it wrong	A drawer click, a kettle hiss, a chair scrape played in reverse	Distortion automated up to 85% by 0:28; delay on the clicks; hiss filtered to a whisper in the Hush

2 · THE PLAN: 50 SECONDS ·



Promise 0:00–0:10, Break 0:10–0:28, Hush 0:28–0:36, Wrong return 0:36–0:50. The plan is 50 seconds: inside my 45–60 second requirement.

3 · CHECKING THE NUMBERS

Promise: 10 clicks, each 1 s apart, which is 60 per minute. Break: 14 clicks whose gaps shrink from 0.9 s to 0.3 s, then stretch to 3.8 s. Return: 8 clicks with gaps of 0.1 s to 3.9 s, so no pulse comes back. Sections: 10 + 18 + 8 + 14 = 50 s.

4 · WHY IT IS ON PURPOSE

A listener hears a clear pulse first, so they know what is being broken. Every sound has a job: the drawer is the pulse, the kettle is the quiet, the reversed chair is the pull. The automation moves with the rule instead of being random.

5 · A SAMPLE ARTIST STATEMENT (ONE PARAGRAPH) ·

"Kitchen Table" breaks the rule that a pulse should stay steady. I recorded a drawer, a kettle and a chair, and for the first ten seconds the drawer clicks once a second like a metronome. Then I sped the clicks up and stretched them out while pushing the distortion higher, until the pulse fell apart, because I wanted the listener to feel a promise being broken. The hiss in the middle is the quiet that follows. When the clicks return they are uneven, so the piece never gets back to normal. Listen for the moment the second click arrives too early.

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STUDENT

Project sheet · requirements and steps

Name _____ Date _____

REQUIREMENTS ·

- ☐ Length: 45–60 seconds
- ☐ Intentionally break at least one major musical convention (structure, tonality, rhythm, etc.)
- ☐ Use Logic's effects and automation to distort or deconstruct sounds
- ☐ Record or create unconventional sound sources
- ☐ Write a brief artist statement (1 paragraph) explaining your approach and concept

STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Define your concept** — Brainstorm what "anti-music" means to you. What rule are you breaking and why? (Concept sheet: page 12)
2. **Gather sounds** — Record or create unconventional sound sources (Sound log: page 13)
3. **Build** — Use Logic to construct your piece. Lean into effects, automation, and distortion. (Build plan: page 14)
4. **Shape** — Even though you're breaking rules, your piece should feel intentional, not accidental. (Build plan: page 14)
5. **Write your artist statement** — Explain what you did and why (Statement planner: page 15)
6. **Finalize** — Mix, bounce, and prepare to present your concept to the class
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

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ANTI-MUSIC MANIFESTO

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Anti-Music Manifesto | Open-Ended Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

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